FINAL REVISION PACK · EXAM TOMORROW

General Awareness & Current Affairs SSC CGL Tier-1 2026

Reverse-engineered from **9 official candidate response sheets** of the 2026 Tier-1 cycle (17–26 September 2026, all decoded answer-marked). Every topic weightage, repeat pattern and trick in this pack is measured from those 224 real questions — not from a generic syllabus list.

224	9	50	3h
REAL GS QUESTIONS DECODED	SHIFTS ANALYSED	MARKS AT STAKE IN GA	PLANNED REVISION TONIGHT

What is inside

- **Part 1 — Score strategy:** the marking maths that decides how many questions you should attempt.
- **Part 2 — Pattern analysis:** topic weightage table + the 12 patterns that repeat inside these 9 shifts.
- **Part 3 — Rapid-fire revision:** ~250 facts in 8 clusters, weighted exactly by what the paper asks.
- **Part 4 — Tricks & shortcuts:** 24 short-cuts, mnemonics, grids and elimination rules.
- **Part 5 — Last 3 hours:** a timed plan, exam-hall checklist and the mistakes that cost marks.

Compiled 26 October 2026 · Sources: SSC CGL 2026 Tier-1 exam pattern (ssc.gov.in notices) + "Phase 14 Grad GS All Shifts" candidate response sheets (17–26 Sep 2026). Answers shown are as marked in the response-sheet key.

1 Know the paper you are writing tomorrow

The GA section is the cheapest 50 marks in the paper. 25 questions, 2 marks each, −0.5 for wrong. No calculation, no formula sheet — only recall and elimination. This is where a well-revised candidate beats a better-prepared one.

1.1 The exact pattern (Tier-1, 2026 cycle)

Section	Questions	Marks	Time	What it really tests
General Intelligence & Reasoning	25	50	15 min	Speed-solvable; target 22+
General Awareness (your section)	25	50	15 min	Recall + elimination; target 21–24
Quantitative Aptitude	25	50	15 min	Calculation speed
English Comprehension	25	50	15 min	Reading + grammar rules
Total	**100**	**200**	**60 min**	Negative marking −0.50 per wrong answer

Tier-1 is qualifying in nature — but the cut-off is decided on this paper, so the score still matters. Some 2026 centres enforced a per-section timer, others ran one composite 60-minute clock. Plan for the tighter case: **budget 11–12 minutes for GA and keep 2 minutes as buffer.**

1.2 The marking maths that should decide your attempt count

Each correct = **+2**, each wrong = **−0.5**. So one wrong answer destroys **one-quarter** of a correct answer. Run the expected value before you guess:

Situation	Probability right	Expected value	Should you mark it?
Blind guess, 4 options	25%	+0.125	Marginally positive. Avoid as a habit.
Two options eliminated (50–50)	50%	+0.75	**Yes. Always.** Biggest scoring lever.
Three options eliminated	~90%	+1.75	Yes, obviously.
You have never heard the term	~15%	−0.275	Leave it. Negative marking is built for this case.

THE RULE WORTH MEMORISING

Break-even accuracy = 0.5 ÷ 2.5 = **20%**. If you can eliminate even one option, your guess is worth more than it costs. If you cannot eliminate even one, **skip**. On a 25-question section this discipline alone typically moves a candidate from ~32 to ~42.

1.3 How to spend the 12 minutes

Minute	Action	Why
0–2	Read all 25 stems fast, answer only the "instant" ones	Static GK, dance, Article, award items — 8–10 exist every shift
2–7	Second pass: the 10-second thinking questions	Statement-based, "correctly matched", chronology
7–10	Elimination pass on the remaining 6–8	Convert 4 options into 2, then mark
10–11	Leave truly unknown ones blank	Protects the negative-marking budget
11–12	Verify you have not mis-clicked; check "marked for review" state	Mis-clicks on a scrollable GA list are common

ORDER TRICK

If the clock is composite (no section lock), **do GA first** — it is the least fatigue-sensitive section, clears in 10 minutes and banks 50 marks early. If the centre enforces a sectional lock, simply use the 12-minute split above.

2 Pattern analysis: what these 9 shifts actually asked

Below is the measured fingerprint of 224 General Awareness questions from 9 shifts (17, 18, 19, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26 September 2026 — Shift-1 papers). Each question was extracted with its correct option. Read the percentages as a revision order, not as gospel.

2.1 Topic weightage — revise in this order

#	Cluster	Qs / 224	Share	What it means for tomorrow
1	**Polity & Constitution**	34	15.2%	Articles, schedules, amendments, doctrine of eclipse, emergency. **Most predictable cluster in the paper.**
2	**Art, Culture, Dance**	33	14.7%	14 dance questions + 7 temple/architecture questions. **Roughly 3–4 questions per shift.**
3	**Geography (incl. census)**	32	14.3%	Hills, passes, minerals, belts + a heavy demographic cluster.
4	**Current Affairs 2025–26**	29	12.9%*	Under-counted by keywords — the true figure is nearer 20%. See 2.2.
5	**Economy & Business**	27	12.1%	Basic concepts + 1991 reforms + definitions. Very scoring because the concepts repeat.
6	**Science — Biology**	17	7.6%	Glands, bones, brain, DNA, biotechnology, deficiency.
7	**History — Modern & Medieval**	17	7.6%	British Acts dominate; the rest is Bhakti/Sufi and dynastic one-liners.
8	**Science — Physics**	14	6.2%	Optics (mirror/lens numericals!), force, pressure, electricity.
9	**International Relations**	10	4.5%	BRICS / Quad / BIMSTEC / neighbourhood dependence.
10	**Science — Chemistry**	7	3.1%	Gases, pollutants, metals, bonds.
11	**Law — BNS / BNSS / BSA**	4–5	~2%	**New cluster.** The three new criminal laws are now a standing question set.

*Method: keyword classification of each stem plus its four options. Clusters with overlapping vocabulary (e.g. a BRICS current-affairs question) are attributed to the dominant theme, so treat the numbers as a weighting guide with ±2% slack.

REPEAT ALERT — THE SINGLE MOST REPEATED QUESTION IN THE SET

Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 appeared in 8 of the 9 shifts — as "which book", "which language", "which author–language pair" or "which English novel". If you revise one current-affairs item tonight, revise the 2025 Sahitya Akademi list. It is effectively a guaranteed 2 marks.

2.2 The 12 patterns these shifts repeat — and how to exploit each

Pattern 1 · One question per shift from each "static block"

Static block	Qs	Frequency across 9 shifts
Dance (classical or folk) → state / deity / feature	14	Present in **all 9 shifts**, often twice
Sahitya Akademi / literary awards 2025	8	**8 of 9 shifts**
Census 2011 / demography numbers	8	5 shifts
ISRO / space mission	7	5 shifts
Temple architecture (Nagara / Dravida / Kerala / Ellora / Dilwara)	7	6 shifts
Article of the Constitution (specific number)	6	5 shifts
Scheme / portal / yojana named in the question	15	7 shifts
Sports (Olympics, Asian Games, doping, records)	11	7 shifts

Exploit: these are the "always there" buckets. Do not enter the hall without the dance grid, the Article map, the census numbers and the awards list at your fingertips.

Pattern 2 · British-era Acts are the backbone of History

Of the modern-history questions, the heaviest sub-block was **constitutional/administrative Acts**: Regulating Act 1773, Pitt's India Act 1784, Charter Acts, Wood's Despatch 1854, Hunter Commission 1882, Indian Councils Act 1909 (Morley–Minto). Three shifts asked the same Regulating-Act/Pitt's-Act content with different statements. **Exploit:** learn each Act as "year → one reform → one defect", nothing more.

Pattern 3 · Statement-based questions ("Only 1 / Only 2 / Both / Neither")

17 of 224 questions used this format — ~2 per shift. They are constructed so that one statement is subtly wrong (a wrong year, a swapped function, an exaggerated claim like "completely", "sole", "only"). **Exploit:** hunt for absolute words. A statement containing only, sole, completely, never, always, first-ever is the one usually being tested as false.

Pattern 4 · "Correctly matched pair" and "NOT / EXCEPT" questions

13 of 224. The distractor is always a near-miss: a real dance with the wrong state, a real mineral in the wrong district, a real scheme with a wrong ministry. **Exploit:** verify both halves. In a NOT/EXCEPT question, three options will be comfortably true — the odd one out is your answer.

Pattern 5 · Same fact, re-framed across shifts

Fact	How it was asked in different shifts
BRICS	4 questions — strategic challenge of expansion, institutional limitation vs EU, why the New Development Bank differs from Bretton Woods, and the year South Africa joined (2010)
Mirror / lens numerical	Concave mirror (h, f, object distance → image height), convex lens (position, height, nature), concave mirror between P and F (nature of image)
Anti-doping	Banned substances (steroids), Therapeutic Use Exemption, whereabouts / Registered Testing Pool, National Anti-Doping Laboratory (New Delhi)
Census 2011	Highest ST proportion, highest slum proportion, sex ratio 0–6, annual growth rate, most populous states, de facto count

Exploit: if you learn the fact once, learn its four faces — number, ranking, definition, and "which state/person".

Pattern 6 · The current-affairs window is very recent and very specific

The events referenced cluster in **late 2025 to April–May 2026**: Justice Surya Kant as 53rd CJI, Harivansh Narayan Singh's third term as Deputy Chairman Rajya Sabha (17 April 2026), Ashwini Bhide as BMC Commissioner (March 2026), a newly discovered tree species (May 2026), the BIMSTEC Games announcement from the 2025 Summit, the Namakkal GI tag (December 2025), Sahitya Akademi 2025, International Day of Forests 2026 theme, and PM Surya Ghar subsidy amounts. **Exploit:** revise the last six months of news, not the whole year.

Pattern 7 · Current affairs is asked as "name → post / name → work"

Not "when did X happen". The grammar is Person → Position, Book → Language, Product → State, Mission → Agency. **Exploit:** memorise pairs, not paragraphs.

Pattern 8 · One numerical per shift lives in GA

Physics numericals (spring constant 1800 N/m; concave mirror magnification 2; convex lens v = 17.14 cm), percentage questions (forest cover 25.17%, growth rate 1.64%, sex ratio 914). **Exploit:** these are 2 marks for anyone who knows the one formula or one number — do not let them be your "leave blank" questions.

Pattern 9 · The three new criminal laws are now a fixed sub-section

BNS 2023 (consent obtained under misconception of fact; coercion; fine-default imprisonment proportional to unpaid amount), BNSS 2023 (police report in a non-cognisable case − deemed to be a complaint), BSA 2023 (res gestae continues with similar principles). **Exploit:** learn 5 exam-favourite provisions; SSC is only asking the headline changes, not the sections.

Pattern 10 · Economy is concept-heavy, not news-heavy

Price elasticity formula, GNP vs GDP, HDI dimensions and the logarithmic income transform, Marshall vs Robbins definitions, output gap, direct vs indirect tax, FRBM Act, the 1991 licensing abolition. **Exploit:** one page of definitions = 4–6 questions.

Pattern 11 · Geography + Demography are bundled

Physical geography (Bhabar belt, Shivalik elevation, Shipki La, iron-ore belts, Hazaribagh mica, Chotanagpur) is asked alongside census/demography (NRR, dependency ratio, de facto count, urbanisation rate). Treat "Indian geography" and "population" as one revision block.

Pattern 12 · Option-position skew (interesting, do not gamble on it)

In this sample the marked correct option fell at position A 22%, B 35%, C 35%, D 8%. That skew is almost certainly an artefact of how these response sheets were assembled. **Do not use it to guess.** Use elimination — the EV table in Part 1 is a far safer edge.

IF YOU HAVE ONLY 45 MINUTES LEFT

Read in this exact order: **3.1 Dance grid → 3.2 Awards 2025 → 3.3 Articles & Schedules → 3.6 Census numbers → 3.4 Optics formulas → 3.7 Current affairs pairs.** These six blocks alone accounted for well over a third of the 224 questions.

3 Rapid-fire revision — ~250 facts in the paper's own order

Clusters are ordered by the weightage measured in Part 2. Items marked **ASKED** were actually asked in these 9 shifts — treat them as the highest-probability repeat set. Learn the grid, then read the rest as one-liners.

3.1 Art, Culture & Dance — the biggest single block (33 questions)

The classical dance grid — memorise this table, not prose

Dance	State	Anchor fact the paper actually tests
Bharatanatyam	Tamil Nadu	Originally called **Sadir** or **Dasiattam** ASKED
Kathak	Uttar Pradesh	Name from **Kathakars = storytellers** ASKED
Kathakali	Kerala	Elaborate make-up, night-long dance-drama
Kuchipudi	Andhra Pradesh	Village of the same name, Krishna district
Odissi	Odisha	Tribhangi posture; temple sculpture roots
Manipuri	Manipur	**Ras Leela** — foot-stamping deliberately minimised to keep spiritual grace ASKED
Mohiniyattam	Kerala	Lasya-dominant, feminine
Sattriya	Assam	Sattra monasteries; Vaishnavite; recognised in 2000 ASKED

Folk dance → state (these are directly asked every shift)

Folk dance	State
Bagurumba	Assam — **Bodo** community ASKED
Kud Dandi Nach	Jammu & Kashmir ASKED
Raas Leela	Manipur ASKED
Dollu Kunitha	Karnataka — dedicated to **Lord Shiva** ASKED
Kavadi Aattam	Tamil Nadu ASKED
Garhwali	Uttarakhand ASKED
Maibi	Manipur ASKED
Raut Nacha	Chhattisgarh ASKED

Folk dance	State
Bhagoria	Madhya Pradesh ASKED
Garba	Gujarat — Navratri ASKED
Gaud Maria	Chhattisgarh — performed at births & marriages ASKED
Shigmo	Goa / Konkan — Sanskritised name **Shishirotsav** ASKED
Karma	MP / Chhattisgarh / Odisha / Jharkhand
Bihu	Assam
Ghoomar	Rajasthan
Lavani	Maharashtra

TRICK — NEVER MIX THESE TWO

Nritta = pure dance, no meaning or mood. **Nritya** = expressive dance (rasa + bhava). **Natya** = drama, the combination. These three words are the answer to a recurring one-liner. ASKED

Temple architecture — 7 questions came from here

Term / monument	Fact
Sandhara temple	The one with a **circumambulatory pathway** (pradakshina path) around the sanctum ASKED
Nirandhara	Same temple type **without** the pathway
Sarvatobhadra	Lit. "good from all sides" — **four entrances**, commonest in Udaipur group
Nagara temple, multi-tower	Main **garbhagriha sits directly under the tallest shikhara** ASKED
Kailasa Temple, Ellora	Carved **top-to-bottom out of a single rock**; Rashtrakuta, Krishna I ASKED
Dilwara temples, Mount Abu	Jain; famous for **marble ceilings with filigree** ASKED

Kerala style	Heavily shaped by the **monsoon — heavy rainfall**, sloping roofs ASKED
Ashtadikpalas	Guardian deities of the eight directions — placed **facing outwards** on the temple walls ASKED
Pondicherry buildings	French element most seen = **arcaded courtyards** ASKED
Dravida vs Nagara	Dravida → vimana + gopuram + temple tank. Nagara → shikhara + amalaka + kalasha. No tank needed.

Art schools & sculpture

- **Gandhara school:** Buddha's face and physique resemble the Greek god **Apollo** — wavy hair, drapery, halo. ASKED
- **Mathura school: spotted red sandstone**; indigenous, fleshier forms, no Greek influence. ASKED
- **Amaravati school:** white marble, narrative reliefs, Satavahana patronage.
- **Lakulisha → Pashupata Shaivism** → precursor of the Kapalika and Kalamukha sects. ASKED
- **Varahamihira** — Brihat Samhita (planetary movements, agriculture, encyclopaedic). ASKED
- **Krishnadevaraya** — Amuktamalyada, an epic poem in **Telugu**. ASKED
- **Ratan Parimoo** — art historian and educator, traditional-art research. ASKED

CHRONOLOGY TRICK — SANSKRIT WORKS, EARLIEST TO LATEST

A-T-B-P: Ashtadhyayi (Panini) → **T**ripitaka → **B**uddhacharita (Ashvaghosha) → **P**arishishtaparvan (Hemachandra). If a chronology question appears, anchor the two ends: Panini is oldest, Hemachandra is youngest (12th century). ASKED

3.2 Awards, books & authors — the guaranteed 2 marks

Award / item	Winner / work	Detail
Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 — Poetry	**Padapurana**	Girijakumar Baliyar Singh, **Odia** ASKED
Sahitya Akademi 2025 — Poetry	**Safar Jaari Hai**	Language: **Urdu** ASKED
Sahitya Akademi 2025 — Poetry	Yogesh Vaidya	Language: **Gujarati** ASKED
Sahitya Akademi 2025 — Short stories	**Bharkhama**	Language: **Rajasthani** ASKED
Sahitya Akademi 2025 — English novel	**Crimson Spring**	Honoured in the English category ASKED
Bal Sahitya Puraskar 2025 — Bengali	**Ekhono Gaye Kata Daye**	Tridib Kumar Chattopadhyay ASKED
International Booker 2025	**Heart Lamp** — Banu Mushtaq	Translated by **Deepa Bhasthi** ASKED
Bharat Ratna 2024	**M. S. Swaminathan**	Architect of India's **Green Revolution** ASKED

HIGHEST-YIELD SINGLE BOX IN THIS PACK

This exact cluster appeared in **8 of 9 shifts**. The pattern is always the same three shapes: (i) book → language, (ii) author → language, (iii) which book won in category X. Learn the six rows above as **book ↔ language** pairs and you cover all three shapes.

3.3 Polity — Articles, Schedules, doctrines

Articles that were asked, and the ones they travel with

Article	Content
13	Laws inconsistent with fundamental rights — **Doctrine of Eclipse** ASKED
21	Life & personal liberty — **cannot be suspended** even during a National Emergency ASKED
52	There shall be a **President of India** ASKED
53	Executive power of the Union vested in the President
74	Council of Ministers to aid and advise the President

Article	Content
280	**Finance Commission** — recommend tax devolution between Centre and States ASKED
352	National Emergency
355	Duty of the Union to protect States against external aggression and internal disturbance ASKED
356	President's Rule — failure of constitutional machinery
368	

75	Other provisions on Ministers; collective responsibility to Lok Sabha
256	**Obligations of States and the Union** — Union may issue directions to States ASKED
257	Control of the Union over States in certain cases
258	Power of the Union to confer powers on States ASKED

	Amendment procedure. **Formation of a new State does NOT need Art 368** — it needs Art 3 ASKED
3	New States / alteration of boundaries; **State Legislature's views must be considered (not binding)** ASKED
1st Amendment	Put land-reform laws into the **Ninth Schedule**; later limited by **I.R. Coelho (2007)** ASKED

MNEMONIC — SCHEDULES 1 TO 12 IN ONE BREATH

States · **E**moluments · **O**aths · **R**ajya Sabha seats · **A**dministration of Scheduled Areas & Scheduled Tribes (5th) · **T**ribal areas of Assam/Meghalaya/Tripura/Mizoram (6th) · **U**nion–State–Concurrent lists (7th, **division of powers** ASKED) · **L**anguages (8th) · **V**alidation of laws / Ninth (land reforms) · **D**efection (10th) · **P**anchayats (11th) · **M**unicipalities (12th). The two the paper actually asks: **7th = division of powers**, **4th = Rajya Sabha seats** ASKED.

Doctrine of basic structure — what has been held, and what has not

- **Held as part of basic structure:** supremacy of the Constitution, republican & democratic form of government, secular character, separation of powers, federal character, **judicial review**, freedom and dignity of the individual, unity and integrity of the nation, rule of law.
- **NOT explicitly held as basic structure: Uniform Civil Code**, right to property (now only a legal right, Art 300A), free and compulsory education (a fundamental right, but not declared basic structure). ASKED
- Source: Kesavananda Bharati (1973) — Parliament cannot amend the basic structure; Minerva Mills (1980) strengthened it.

Emergency, legislature and courts — quick logic

- **Fundamental rights suspended** — by the **President**, during a National Emergency (Art 358 & 359), but **Art 21 never**. ASKED
- **Union legislating on a State List subject** — during President's Rule (Art 356), or under Art 249 (Rajya Sabha resolution), or when two or more States request it (Art 252), or to implement international treaties (Art 253). ASKED
- **First Chief Justice of the Supreme Court at Calcutta** (British India) — **Elijah Impey**. ASKED
- **Justice Surya Kant** — took oath as the **53rd Chief Justice of India** in 2025. ASKED
- **Harivansh Narayan Singh** — re-elected **Deputy Chairman of the Rajya Sabha** for a third consecutive term on 17 April 2026. ASKED

3.4 General Science — physics first, because it carries a numerical

The optics toolkit (one numerical per shift came from here)

Formula / rule	Statement	Sign convention in one line
Mirror formula	1/v + 1/u = 1/f	Distances measured from the pole; **u is negative** always; f negative for concave, positive for convex
Lens formula	1/v − 1/u = 1/f	u negative; f positive for convex, negative for concave
Magnification	m = h′/h = −v/u (mirror) · v/u (lens)	**m negative → real & inverted**; m positive → virtual & erect
Power	P = 1/f (in metres) · unit dioptre	Convex +, concave −

10-SECOND SHORTCUT FOR THE ACTUAL QUESTIONS ASKED

Q (asked): h = 1 cm, u = 24 cm, concave mirror, f = 16 cm.
Step 1 — 1/v = 1/f − 1/u = −1/16 + 1/24 → v = −48 cm (real, in front of mirror).
Step 2 — m = −v/u = −(−48)/(−24) = −2 → image is **inverted and twice as tall = 2.0 cm**. ASKED
Q (asked): h = 4 cm, u = 24 cm, convex lens, f = 10 cm → v = 17.14 cm, h′ = 2.86 cm, **real and inverted**. ASKED
Rule of thumb that saves the whole question: for a concave mirror / convex lens, if the object is **beyond f**, the image is real & inverted; if the object is **between pole and f**, the image is virtual, erect and magnified (behind the mirror). ASKED

Physics one-liner	Answer
Gravity twice as strong	**Atmospheric pressure rises significantly** ASKED
Friction removed entirely	Object moves on **forever at constant velocity** ASKED
Diamond sparkles	High refractive index → **dispersion + total internal reflection** ASKED
Metals conduct	**Free electrons** that move easily ASKED
Earth's axial tilt	**23.4°** (≈23.5°) ASKED
Geoid shape	Reflects **global gravity variations** ASKED

Physics one-liner	Answer
Lagrange points	Reduce **fuel needed for stable positioning** ASKED
Longest day in June	The place at the **higher latitude** (e.g. Delhi over southern cities) ASKED
Spring constant	From ½mv² = ½kx² → k = mv²/x² ASKED
Ionosphere	Reflects radio waves — makes long-distance radio possible (that statement is **correct**) ASKED
Presbyopia	Ageing and weakening of the **ciliary muscles** ASKED
Dry air composition	N_2 **78.1%**, O_2 **20.9%**; Ne 0.0018%, He 0.0005%, O_3 0.00006% ASKED

Biology — glands, bones and biomolecules

Question shape	Answer
Hormone of the pineal gland	**Melatonin** (melanin is a pigment — classic trap) ASKED
Smallest individual bone	**Stapes** (in the middle ear) ASKED
Cervical spine → base of head	**Pivot joint** ASKED
Posture and balance	**Cerebellum** ASKED
Yogurt fermentation	**Streptococcus thermophilus** ASKED
Bt cotton gene source	**Bacillus thuringiensis** ASKED
Golden rice produces	**Beta-carotene** (vitamin A precursor) ASKED

Question shape	Answer
DNA first called "nuclein" (1869)	**Friedrich Miescher** ASKED
Hershey–Chase used radioactive P	To **label viral DNA** ASKED
Antigens stimulate immunity	By **binding to lymphocytes and activating them** ASKED
Phosphorus is essential because	It forms the **backbone of nucleic acids** ASKED
Promoter region of a transcription unit	**Binding site for RNA polymerase** ASKED
Regenerative medicine's goal	**Repair/replace damaged tissue using stem cells** ASKED
Not a biotechnology product	**Herbal medicine** ASKED

Chemistry & environment

- **Ground-level ozone (O_3)** = a major **air pollutant**; ozone in the stratosphere = protective shield. ASKED
- **India's NAQI:** pollutants are PM10, PM2.5, NO_2, SO_2, CO, O_3, NH_3 and Pb. **CO and O_3 use an 8-hour averaging period**; the rest 24-hour. ASKED
- **Final NAQI value = the highest sub-index value** (not an average). ASKED
- **US AQI colour codes:** green = good, yellow = moderate, orange = unhealthy for sensitive groups, red = unhealthy, purple = very unhealthy, **maroon = hazardous**. ASKED
- Water molecule → **two** O–H hydrogen bonds' worth of structure; N_2 has a triple bond; O_2 double.

3.5 History — British Acts are the surest 2 marks in this section

Act / event	Year	The reform it made	The defect the paper tests
Regulating Act	1773	Parliament controls EIC; **Supreme Court at Calcutta — 1 Chief Justice + 3 judges**; Governor of Bengal became **Governor-General of Fort William** ASKED	Did **not** "reduce the Governor of Bengal to Governor of Fort William" as a downgrade — the trick statement
Pitt's India Act	1784		Madras & Bombay were subordinated to Bengal in

		Created the **Board of Control**; separated the EIC's **commercial and political functions** ASKED	**war and treaty** matters, not merely revenue
Permanent Settlement	1793	Zamindars became the revenue collectors/ owners	Peasants did **not** become legal owners of land ASKED
Ryotwari System	1792 →	**Alexander Read** and Thomas Munro; introduced in the **Madras Presidency** first, then Bombay ASKED	Peasants were recognised as owners, but the tax burden was **not** reduced
Wood's Despatch	1854	"Magna Carta of English education"; English promoted as a medium	It did **not** make English the **sole** medium excluding vernaculars ASKED
Hunter Commission	1882	Reviewed education; stressed expansion of **primary and secondary** education ASKED	—
Indian Councils Act (Morley–Minto)	1909	Enlarged legislative councils; introduced **separate electorates by religion** — seen as divisive ASKED	Did **not** permit supplementary questions / budget resolutions ASKED
Railway Board	1905	Recommended by the **Thomas Robertson Commission** ASKED	Trap options: Raleigh / Sargent / Sadler commissions

TRICK — THE "REFORM + DEFECT" FRAME

Every statement-based history question is built from one true reform plus one exaggerated claim. Therefore, when a statement says a British Act **"made X the sole/only/completely..."**, assume it is false until proven otherwise. That single rule resolved most of the statement questions in these shifts.

Ancient, medieval and Bhakti–Sufi one-liners

Question	Answer
4th Buddhist Council	**Kundalvana, Kashmir**; under Kanishka; presided by **Vasumitra**; led to Mahayana and image worship ASKED
Founded the Pushti Marga	**Vallabhacharya** (Bhagavatam-based devotion) ASKED
Sufi saint in the Adi Granth	**Baba Farid** ASKED
Neither ruled Delhi nor founded a dynasty	**Mahmud of Ghazni** ASKED
Two women rulers who reigned as sovereign	**Razia Sultana** and **Rudramadevi** ASKED

Question	Answer
Gupta-era ports	Gantasala, Kadura, Chal, Poduka, Pohar, Korakai, Kamara — trade with SE Asia & the Mediterranean ASKED
Veerangana museum, Jhansi	In memory of **Jhalkari Bai** ASKED
Kailasa temple patron	Rashtrakuta **Krishna I**
Ashtadhyayi author	**Panini** (oldest of the set tested)
Buddhacharita author	**Ashvaghosha**

3.6 Geography + Demography — 32 questions, and half are pure numbers

Question	Answer
Shevaroy Hills	**Tamil Nadu** (Eastern Ghats, Salem) ASKED
Pebble belt south of the Shivalik	**Bhabar** ASKED
Average elevation of the Shivalik	**600–1500 m** ASKED
Sutlej's entry pass from Tibet	**Shipki La** ASKED
Rice bowl of India	**Krishna-Godavari delta** ASKED

Question	Answer
Not an iron-ore belt	**Ludhiana–Delhi–Kanpur** (the real belts: Odisha–Jharkhand, Durg–Bastar–Chandrapur, Ballari–Chitradurga, Ratnagiri) ASKED
Why Chotanagpur is a mineral storehouse	**Ancient rock formations + tectonic stability** ASKED
Norwesters in Assam	**Bardoli Chheerha** (Bengal = Kalbaisakhi; Kerala = Mango showers) ASKED

Largest jowar producer	**Maharashtra** ASKED
Uranium in Chhattisgarh	**Durg** district ASKED
Hazaribagh plateau mineral	**Mica** ASKED

Coal / petroleum / gas pattern	Coal in the **east-central** belt; petroleum **off the west coast and Assam**; gas onshore + offshore ASKED
Diamond cutting & polishing	**Surat** ASKED
Integral Coach Factory	**Perambur**, Chennai ASKED
Market-oriented industry	**Bakery products** ASKED
Maize climate	**Semi-arid** ASKED

THE CENSUS BLOCK — 8 QUESTIONS, ALL PURE RECALL

Fact (Census 2011)	Number / answer
Highest **proportion** of ST population	**Mizoram** (~94.4%) — note: highest number is Madhya Pradesh ASKED
Highest share of urban population in slums	**Andhra Pradesh** ASKED
Sex ratio, age group 0–6	**914** (overall sex ratio 943) ASKED
Annual growth rate of population	**1.64%** (2001–11) ASKED
Three most populous states, descending	**Uttar Pradesh → Maharashtra → Bihar** ASKED
Old-age dependency ratio	**~14.2%** ASKED
De facto count	**Population present at the time of the census** (de jure = usual residence) ASKED
NRR = 1 means	A woman **replaces herself** in the population ASKED
Census town criteria	Pop ≥ 5,000 · density ≥ 400/km² · **≥75% of male workers in non-agricultural work** ("50% in agriculture" is the false statement) ASKED
Indicators **not** in the census	**Household income** and **caste** (religion and literacy are counted) ASKED

3.7 Economy — one page of definitions = 4–6 questions

Concept	Answer
Price elasticity of demand	**% change in quantity demanded ÷ % change in price** ASKED
GNP − GDP	**Net factor income from abroad** ASKED
Output gap	**Potential GDP − actual GDP** ASKED
HDI health dimension	**Life expectancy at birth** ASKED
HDI income dimension	GNI per capita passed through a **logarithmic transformation** ASKED
Marshall vs Robbins	Marshall = **welfare** & material requisites of well-being; Robbins = **scarcity & allocation** ASKED
Direct then indirect tax	**Income tax** then **GST** ASKED
Not an exception to the law of demand	

Concept	Answer
Post-1991 industrial reform	**Abolition of licensing in all but a few industries** ASKED
Dismantled in the 1991 trade reforms	**Quantitative restrictions on imports** ASKED
Maharatna / Navratna / Miniratna	**Retained in the public sector** ASKED
Fiscal discipline law after 1991	**FRBM Act, 2003** ASKED
Why India drew outsourcing	**Low wage rates + skilled manpower** ASKED
Basic Needs Approach	Proposed by the **ILO**; criticized for ignoring human choice ASKED
ONGC overseas push	E&P projects in **16 countries** ASKED
Economics as the study of choice	Because **scarce resources must be allocated among competing uses** ASKED

	Substitute goods (exceptions: Giffen goods, veblen goods, speculation, necessities) ASKED

3.8 Current affairs & international relations — learn pairs, not paragraphs

Person / item	Answer	The exact shape in which it was asked
Preeti Rajak	First woman in the Indian Army promoted to **Subedar**	Rank-based MCQ ASKED
Bobby Mukkamala	First person of Indian origin elected **President-elect of the American Medical Association**	"First PIO to..." ASKED
Maya Neelakantan	Guitar prodigy from **Chennai**	Person → city ASKED
Pratyay Amrit	**Chief Secretary of Bihar**	Person → post ASKED
Ashwini Bhide	Municipal Commissioner, **BMC** (March 2026)	Person → post ASKED
Maruti Chitampalli	**Wildlife conservationist and writer** (died 18 June 2025)	Obituary → field ASKED
Namakkal Maakkal Pathirangal (GI, Dec 2025)	**Soapstone cookware**, Tamil Nadu	Product → category ASKED
Humboldtiana niriana (May 2026)	New evergreen tree species found in **Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuary**, Kerala	Species → protected area ASKED
CE20 cryogenic engine	Powers the **upper stage of LVM3**	Engine → stage ASKED
SCE-200 semi-cryogenic engine	Uses an **oxidizer-rich staged combustion cycle**	Engine → cycle ASKED
NISAR	Carries **dual-frequency synthetic aperture radar**	Satellite → payload ASKED
Axiom-4	Associated with the **International Space Station**	Mission → platform ASKED
XPoSat launch (1 Jan 2024)	ISRO Chairman at the time: **S. Somanath**	Mission → person ASKED
PM-MITRA	**7** textile parks being established	Scheme → number ASKED
PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana	Maximum subsidy for a **3 kW** rooftop plant = **₹78,000**	Scheme → amount ASKED
Atal Tinkering Labs	**10,000** established (as of Oct 2025)	Scheme → number ASKED
Digital Agriculture Mission	DPI = **Digital Public Infrastructure**	Expansion of an abbreviation ASKED
e-Shram	National database of **unorganised workers**, incl. gig/platform workers	Portal → purpose ASKED
BIMSTEC Games	India to host the first-ever edition in **2027**	Event → year ASKED
International Day of Forests 2026	Theme: **"Forests and Economies"**	Day → theme ASKED
India's climate-risk rank (2019)	**7th** most affected	Index → rank ASKED
Forest & tree cover (ISFR 2023)	**25.17%** of geographical area	Report → percentage ASKED

Reduce household solid-fuel use	Pledged **50%**	Policy → number ASKED

Sports block — 11 questions across 7 shifts

- **Michael Phelps** — most Olympic gold medals in history ASKED
- **Saina Nehwal** — India's first Olympic badminton medal ASKED
- **China** — most golds at the 2023 Asian Games ASKED
- **Chess** entered the Asian Games in **2006** ASKED
- **Dutee Chand** — four-year ban from late 2022 ASKED
- **Bhawna** — recurve women's gold, World Archery Para Series, Bangkok (April 2026) ASKED
- **Antis** in kabaddi = the **defenders** ASKED
- **TUE** = Therapeutic Use Exemption — permitted medical use of a prohibited substance with official approval ASKED

International relations — the four BRICS questions are one idea

- **South Africa joined in 2010**, turning BRIC into BRICS. ASKED
- The **biggest strategic challenge** of expansion = **managing competing regional rivalries** among members. ASKED
- The **biggest institutional limitation vs the EU** = **no binding supranational legal authority**. ASKED
- The **New Development Bank** differs from the Bretton Woods institutions because it lends **without political/economic conditionalities**. ASKED
- **Quad** infrastructure goal = create an **alternative to the Belt and Road Initiative**. ASKED
- **China supports BRICS expansion** to increase the **collective bargaining power of non-Western economies**. ASKED
- **Bhutan's dependence on India** covers defence, trade and hydropower — **not** nuclear technology. ASKED
- **Chabahar port** → potential regional stability through economic interdependence. ASKED

3.9 The new criminal laws — a brand-new but fixed sub-section

Law	The one provision that was asked
BNS 2023	**Consent is invalid if obtained under a misconception of fact.** Consent given under fear of instant death is not free consent; and where a fine is partly paid, default imprisonment must be **proportionate to the unpaid part**. ASKED
BNSS 2023	A police report on a **non-cognisable** offence is **deemed to be a complaint and the police officer the complainant**. ASKED
BSA 2023	**Res gestae** (relevancy of facts forming part of the same transaction) **continues with similar principles** as the old Evidence Act. ASKED

The CGL-2026 pattern is to ask only the headline change, never a section number. If a BNS/BNSS/BSA question appears tomorrow, an answer phrased as "continues with the earlier principle, with a procedural change" is usually right.

4 Tricks, shortcuts & elimination rules

Twenty-four techniques, each one small enough to use inside 10 seconds. Technique beats knowledge when the knowledge is 80% there — which, on the night before, it is.

4.1 Elimination — the four questions to ask in order

#	Ask yourself	What to do with the answer
1	**Is any option absurd or self-contradictory?**	Kill it instantly. About 1 in 4 questions has one throwaway option.
2	**Does one option contain an absolute word (only, sole, never, all, first-ever)?**	In statement-based questions this is usually the false claim. In direct questions it is often the answer, so check the wording of the stem.
3	**Do two options say almost the same thing?**	Neither can be right — the answer must be distinguishable. Eliminate both.
4	**Does the stem say NOT / EXCEPT?**	Three options will sound comfortably true. **Pick the one that feels "off"**, not the one that feels best.

THE SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT SENTENCE IN THIS PACK

Getting a question from 4 options to 2 options turns a −0.5 liability into a **+0.75 expected gain**. Do this on every question you are unsure about, and you will out-score a better-read candidate who guesses blind.

4.2 Subject-specific shortcuts

① Optics in 10 seconds

- Concave mirror / convex lens + object **beyond f** → image **real, inverted**. Object **within f** → **virtual, erect, magnified**.
- Magnitude of m = |v/u|. If the option set is "Erect/Inverted × two sizes", compute m only — the nature almost always follows from the sign.
- Concave mirror, f = 16, u = 24 → v = −48, m = −2 → **inverted, 2 cm**. The mirror questions in this cycle were all one-step versions of this.

② Direct vs indirect tax — one word test

Does the burden **shift**? Income tax, corporate tax, capital gains → cannot be shifted → **direct**. GST, customs, excise → passed on to the consumer → **indirect**. If an option pairs "Income tax — GST" in that order, it is the answer shape SSC wants. **ASKED**

③ Statement questions (Only 1 / Only 2 / Both / Neither) — the 3-step filter

1. Read statement 1 alone. If you are sure it is **false** → the answer is "Only 2" or "Neither". Two options survive.
2. Read statement 2 alone. Almost always one of the two is a textbook truth — that decides it.
3. Only if both look true, check for the exaggeration word. "Completely", "sole", "only in matters of revenue", "reduced the status of" — these are where the setter hides the error.

④ Dance & culture — the geography instinct

When a folk dance is unfamiliar, use the name's language family and the state's dominant tribe:

- Ends in **-bumba, -bihu, -bagurumba** → Assam / Bodo belt.
- **Kud, Dandi, Nach** in the north-west → Jammu & Kashmir / Himachal.
- **Kunitha** → Karnataka. **Aattam** → Tamil Nadu. **Leela / Raas / Maibi** → Manipur.
- **Garba, Ghoomar, Bhavai** → Gujarat / Rajasthan (Navratri and desert belt).

⑤ Article numbers — build on four anchors

Anchor Art **52** (President) and count forward: 53 executive power, 74 Council of Ministers, 75 other provisions, 76 Attorney General. Anchor Art **352** (National Emergency) and step: 355 duty to protect States, 356 President's Rule, 360 Financial Emergency. Everything else hangs off these two ladders. **ASKED**

⑥ Schedules — 4, 7, 9, 10, 11, 12 is all you need

4 = Rajya Sabha seats · **7** = three lists (division of powers) · **9** = laws shielded from judicial review (I.R. Coelho) · **10** = anti-defection · **11** = panchayats · **12** = municipalities. **ASKED**

⑦ British Acts — the "reform then defect" template

For every Act remember exactly one reform and one defect. Regulating Act 1773 → reform: Supreme Court at Calcutta; defect: Governor-General's powers were vague. Pitt's 1784 → reform: Board of Control; defect: dyarchy in administration. 1909 → reform: enlarged councils; defect: separate electorates. This template lets you answer statement questions without memorising the statements.

⑧ Current affairs — always answer the "pair" the question is built around

The stem contains a noun and the options are four different companions. Identify the **category** first (person→post, book→language, product→state, mission→agency, scheme→number). Once the category is clear, 2 of the 4 options are usually wrong on category alone.

⑨ Awards — the language is the discriminator

Sahitya Akademi questions are almost always decided by **language**, not by author. Learn book → language; the author name usually only confirms it. **ASKED**

⑩ Census numbers — sort, don't memorise

Learn the direction of each ranking, not the digits: ST **proportion** → north-east state; ST **number** → central state; slums → a southern state; sex ratio 0–6 → **below 1000**; growth rate → **between 1.5 and 1.7**; population order → U, M, B. Options are usually far enough apart that direction alone wins.

⑪ Science abbreviations the paper loves

Term	Full form / meaning	One hook
NAQI	National Air Quality Index	Value = **worst** sub-index, not the average
TUE	Therapeutic Use Exemption	Anti-doping: medical permission
RTP	Registered Testing Pool	Athletes who must file whereabouts
DPI	Digital Public Infrastructure	Digital Agriculture Mission
NISAR	NASA-ISRO SAR mission	Dual-frequency radar
SCE-200	Semi-cryogenic engine	Oxidizer-rich staged combustion
BNS / BNSS / BSA	Nyaya / Nagarik Suraksha / Sakshya	Penal / procedure / evidence

⑫ The "which is NOT" flip

Answer the question in the positive first — "which of these are true?" — then pick the leftover. Doing it in the negative order is where most errors happen under time pressure.

⑬ Time-saving: the 15-second abandon rule

If after 15 seconds you have no elimination and no recall, leave the question and move on. GA does not reward staring; the next question is often a 5-second dance or award item. Return only if a later question jogs your memory.

⑭ When two options are "both plausible and famous"

SSC rarely uses obscure answers. If one option is the textbook-famous entity (Mizoram for ST proportion, Thomas Robertson for the Railway Board, Vallabhacharya for Pushti Marga) and the other is a plausible but less-canonical choice, the canonical one is right. **ASKED**

⑮ The "same word appears in stem and option" signal

Setters often leave a lexical clue. If the stem says **circumambulatory**, the answer option tends to carry **pathway**. Use it as a tie-breaker only, never as the primary method.

⑯ Physics numericals — dimension check

Before solving, look at the units in the options. If the question asks for a spring constant, units must be N/m; anything else (energy, momentum) is dead. This removes 1–2 options without any calculation. **ASKED**

⑰ Grouping trick for classical vs folk

Only **eight** classical dances exist. If a stem names something not on that list of eight and calls it classical, the statement is false. Folk = everything else, and folk questions are always "dance → state". **ASKED**

⑱ The Manipur / Assam / Odisha triad

Three states generate a disproportionate number of culture questions: **Manipur** (Ras Leela, Maibi, Thang-ta), **Assam** (Sattriya, Bihu, Bagurumba, Bardoli Chheerha), **Odisha** (Odissi, Padapurana's language). If a culture question is a total blank, the odds sit with these three.

⑲ Demography definitions in one line each

De facto = present at census time · **De jure** = usual residence · **NRR = 1** = mother replaced by one daughter · **CBR high** = early stage of demographic transition · **dependency ratio** = non-working ÷ working population. **ASKED**

⑳ Environmental numbers worth 30 seconds

Forest & tree cover **25.17%** · India's climate-risk rank **7th** (2019) · household solid-fuel reduction pledge **50%** · dry air N_2 **78.1%** / O_2 **20.9%** · US AQI maroon = **hazardous**. **ASKED**

㉑ Scheme numbers — the "3–7–10" cluster

PM-MITRA: 7 parks · **PM Surya Ghar: ₹78,000 for 3 kW** · **Atal Tinkering Labs: 10,000** · **ONGC: 16 countries** · **BIMSTEC Games: 2027**. Five numbers, five likely questions. **ASKED**

㉒ If a question is about a "new law", prefer the continuity answer

The three new criminal laws largely re-enact the old principles with procedural modernisation. Therefore in BNS/BNSS/BSA questions, options saying "continues with similar principles", "deemed to be", or "proportionate to" are usually right, and options saying "abolished" or "no longer applies" are usually wrong. **ASKED**

㉓ Geography — the belt/feature test

For "which state / which district" questions, locate the feature's **geological belt** first (Himalayan, peninsular, coastal, Deccan Trap). Mica → Jharkhand belt (Hazaribagh, Koderma, Gaya). Uranium → Chhattisgarh (Durg) and Jharkhand (Jaduguda). Iron ore → Odisha–Jharkhand–Chhattisgarh–Karnataka. **ASKED**

㉔ The 2-second re-read before you click

On GA, mis-reading "NOT" or "except" costs a full 2 marks and cannot be recovered. Re-read only the last three words of the stem before clicking. This is the highest-return two seconds in the exam.

5 The last three hours, and the exam hall

A fixed plan removes decision fatigue. Follow it without negotiating with yourself — additional material now adds less than good sleep and clean execution.

5.1 A timed plan for tonight (≈3 hours, then sleep)

Block	Time	Do this	Why this order
Block 1	40 min	Art & Culture (3.1) + Awards (3.2)	Largest and most repeated clusters; pure recall, no reasoning needed
Block 2	35 min	Polity (3.3) — Articles, Schedules, basic structure, emergency	Most predictable cluster; the Article ladder pays off instantly
Block 3	30 min	Current affairs pairs (3.8) — read aloud once	Reading pairs aloud fixes them better than silent reading
Block 4	25 min	Science (3.4) + the optics shortcuts (4.2①)	Guarantees the numerical and the biology set
Block 5	25 min	Geography + census block (3.6)	Numbers are easy to hold for 12 hours if revised last
Block 6	20 min	History Acts table (3.5) + Economy (3.7)	Both are template-driven; the tables are enough
Block 7	15 min	The 24 tricks in Part 4 (skim only)	You want the elimination rules fresh, not memorised anew
Block 8	10 min	Close everything. Sleep.	Sleep is worth more than one more PDF. Genuinely.

WHAT NOT TO DO TONIGHT

- **Do not start a new topic** you have never touched. Unfamiliar material at midnight produces anxiety, not marks.
- **Do not take a full mock at 11 pm.** A bad score now will cost you more in confidence than it teaches you.
- **Do not read the 2024 or earlier current-affairs compilations.** The window that these shifts tested is late 2025 – mid 2026.
- **Do not attempt 25/25 tomorrow out of bravado.** 23 attempts with 21 correct beats 25 attempts with 18 correct.

5.2 Exam-hall checklist

Documents & logistics

- Admit card — **printed**, plus a spare copy
- Original photo ID matching the admit card
- Passport-size photograph (same as the application)
- Reach the centre **90 minutes early**; entry closes before the shift begins
- No watch, phone, calculator, or metal items — expect frisking delays
- Carry water and a light snack for after the paper, not during

On-screen process

- Read the instructions screen fully — it states whether sections are locked
- Use **Save & Next** every time; unsaved answers do not count
- Mark doubtful ones for review, but **do not leave them unmarked** if you have eliminated one option
- Check the clock only after finishing a section, not during each question

Behaviour inside the GA section

- First pass: answer the 8–10 instant recalls. Never linger.
- Second pass: statement and matching questions, using the 4-step elimination.
- Third pass: convert the rest to two options and mark.
- Leave blank only when every option is unfamiliar.
- Re-read the last three words of any NOT/EXCEPT stem before clicking.
- If a question is about a name you have never heard, guess the option that sounds like the **most famous** plausible entity.

THE 60-SECOND RESET

If the first three GA questions go badly, stop, breathe for ten seconds, and restart from question 4. Panic in GA costs 3–4 marks; the section is designed to be recovered within minutes because every question is independent.

5.3 A 15-question self-check (answers below — all appeared in these 9 shifts)

1. Hormone secreted by the pineal gland?
2. Which schedule divides powers between the Union and the States?
3. Bagurumba is a folk dance of which community?
4. Book that won the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 in Odia?
5. Narrow pebble belt south of the Shivalik?
6. Price elasticity of demand formula?
7. Smallest bone in the human body?
8. Article that cannot be suspended during a National Emergency?
1. Average elevation of the Shivalik range?
2. Who was the 53rd Chief Justice of India?
3. Country that won the most golds at the 2023 Asian Games?
4. Institution that proposed the Basic Needs Approach?
5. Stage of LVM3 powered by the CE20 engine?
6. Highest proportion of ST population, Census 2011?
7. Meaning of "Antis" in kabaddi?

ANSWERS

1. Melatonin · **2.** Seventh Schedule · **3.** Bodo, Assam · **4.** Padapurana (Girijakumar Baliyar Singh) · **5.** Bhabar · **6.** $\%\Delta Q \div \%\Delta P$ · **7.** Stapes · **8.** Article 21 · **9.** 600–1500 m · **10.** Justice Surya Kant · **11.** China · **12.** ILO · **13.** Upper stage · **14.** Mizoram · **15.** Defenders.

5.4 Target-setting for tomorrow

GA attempt profile	Realistic GA score	Reading of the outcome
25 attempted, 18 correct	32.5	Over-attempting. Three of those seven wrong answers were probably never going to be right.
23 attempted, 20 correct	38.5	Solid. This is the shape to aim for.
23 attempted, 22 correct	**43.5**	Excellent — the revision pack has done its job.
20 attempted, 20 correct	40.0	Perfect discipline; leaves nothing on the table but nothing lost either.

Remember that Tier-1 is qualifying and the marks are not carried into the final merit list — but the Tier-1 score decides whether you get to sit for Tier-2 at all. Clean, disciplined GA attempt is the cheapest way to protect the cut-off.

References & how this pack was built

- **Question data:** "Phase 14 Grad GS All shifts — Siddhi Prep" candidate response sheets, 42 pages covering 9 shifts (17, 18, 19, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26 September 2026, Shift-1). All 42 pages were image-OCR'd, and each question's correct option was recovered from the response-sheet colour marks (green/yellow = correct, red = candidate's error). 224 questions were decoded; ~3% of blocks were partially legible and are excluded from the counts.
- **Exam pattern:** SSC CGL 2026 Tier-1 schedule notice dated 12 September 2026 (F.No. HQ-EC033/7/2025-EC) — Tier-1 CBE conducted 30 September to 30 October 2026; pattern of 4 sections × 25 questions × 2 marks, 60 minutes, −0.50 negative marking.
- **Static content:** standard NCERT/SSC-level polity, history, geography, science and economy facts, cross-checked against what the nine shifts actually asked.
- **Caution:** where a response-sheet key appeared internally inconsistent (e.g. an Article number question), this pack states the constitutional position and flags the discrepancy rather than teaching the disputed key.

Prepared 26 October 2026 for a candidate writing SSC CGL Tier-1 on 27 October 2026. Use Part 3 as the reading sheet and Part 4 as the execution sheet — nothing else is needed in the hall.